

Fact Sheet Template

Create a concise, evidence-based case for a policy proposal. Aim for a focused, readable two-page handout whenever possible, and cite reliable sources throughout.

Policy summary

Write one sentence that names the proposal and states what it will accomplish.

What is the problem in the status quo?

Explain the specific social harm the policy should correct. Who is harmed? How do effects vary by geography, age, race, or income? What can be measured, and what happens if the issue is ignored?

Why is this a priority now?

Identify the external effects of the problem and the reasons different communities or policymakers should care about it.

How did the problem arise?

Diagnose the cause. Consider history, funding, regulation, implementation, social norms, stakeholder incentives, loopholes, or unclear definitions.

What could complicate a response?

Acknowledge possible tradeoffs, unintended effects, and other variables that may affect the problem or the proposal.

How does the proposed policy correct the problem?

Show the connection between the proposed action and the underlying cause. Explain accepted knowledge, relevant evidence, similar programs, or pilot results.

What impacts can we expect?

Tie the solution back to the original harms. Identify beneficiaries, measurable outcomes, potential savings, access improvements, equity effects, and broader community benefits.

Weigh the impacts

Address both positive and negative outcomes. A strong fact sheet makes its assumptions visible and explains why the overall case supports action.

Source checklist

Prioritize government data, peer-reviewed journals, and university policy reviews. Use reliable sources and balance advocacy sources with independent or cross-perspective evidence.

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